



Acceptable Use Policy



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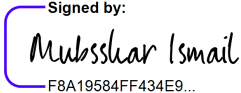
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to define the standards for the professional and ethical use of IBEX technology resources. By governing these assets, we aim to safeguard the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of our data. This policy serves to mitigate technical risks while ensuring compliance with applicable legal, regulatory, and contractual obligations.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, consultants, and third-party partners (collectively defined as 'Users') who access or manage IBEX information systems. The scope extends to all IBEX-owned hardware, software, network infrastructure, and digital assets, regardless of their location.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Roles	Responsibilities
Users	- Follow all requirements stated within the policy. - Safeguard all company-issued hardware and protect sensitive credentials from unauthorized access. - Promptly report any suspicious activity, lost or stolen assets, or potential security breaches to the IT Security team
IT Security	Maintain and update the policy to ensure it aligns with the evolving threat landscape and organizational needs.
IT Teams	- Implement and maintain the technical security controls and configurations required to enforce this policy across the infrastructure. - Ensure that technology resources are configured to prevent unauthorized use or policy bypass
Compliance Team	Lead investigations into potential policy violations and coordinate with Legal, HR, and Management as required.
Human Resource (HR)	Oversee the disciplinary process for policy violations to ensure fair enforcement and maintain organizational integrity.

4. Policy

4.1. General Use and Ownership

- 1) All information created, processed, transmitted, or stored on IBEX systems for business purposes remains the exclusive property of IBEX. While the organization does not claim ownership of incidental personal data (such as personal webmail or banking accessed in breach of policy), the organization maintains full ownership and control over the assets and infrastructure used to access it.
- 2) To ensure network integrity, security maintenance, and policy compliance, IBEX reserves the right to monitor and audit all network traffic, system activity, and use of company-owned equipment at any time
- 3) Corporate assets are provided strictly for approved business purposes; the processing or storage of non-work-related data is prohibited. Users should have no expectation of privacy regarding any activity performed on or through company resources.

- 4) The use of social networking sites on corporate assets is strictly prohibited unless specifically authorized for business functions. Authorized users must adhere to the guidelines, and any personal use—where permitted by exception—must not compromise the organization's security or reputation.
- 5) All use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) solutions must receive prior authorization and strictly adhere to the IBEX AI Policy to ensure data privacy and ethical compliance.
- 6) To mitigate the risk of data exposure, users shall refrain from uploading or inputting business data into public AI tools. Only corporate-authorized AI platforms shall be utilized for processing IBEX information assets.

4.2. Security and Proprietary Information

- 7) Access to sensitive information shall be strictly restricted to authorized personnel based on the principle of "least privilege" and a "need-to-know" basis. All such access shall require documented prior management approval.
- 8) The following mandatory controls shall be enforced when handling sensitive or confidential information:
 - a. **Physical (Non-electronic) information**
 - a) Physical documents shall be stored in secure locations, such as locked drawers or filing cabinets, situated within restricted-access areas protected by physical keys or electronic access cards.
 - b) All sensitive physical media shall be clearly labeled and sealed. Transportation of such materials shall be conducted exclusively by authorized personnel.
 - c) When no longer required, paper documents shall be destroyed using a cross-cut shredder to ensure information is unrecoverable.
 - b. **Electronic information**
 - a) Electronic sensitive data shall be stored only within encrypted directories or folders with strictly managed access permissions.
 - b) The transmission of sensitive information via email shall be restricted. Where business necessity exists, such data must be protected by enterprise-approved encryption methods.
 - c) Sensitive information shall not be transmitted or stored via voicemail systems or answering machines.
- 9) Users shall appropriately classify data and apply required security controls when transmitting or storing information within IBEX-approved repositories.
- 10) Only authorized users shall share sensitive or confidential information, and such transfers shall be conducted exclusively through approved secure channels.
- 11) Users shall have no expectation of privacy regarding any data stored, sent, or received via IBEX systems. The organization reserves the right to monitor all corporate information assets.
- 12) Access to IBEX emails shall only be approved on IBEX owned assets.
- 13) Users shall secure their passwords in alignment with the Password Policy. Account sharing is strictly prohibited; users shall be held personally accountable for all activities performed under their assigned credentials.

- 14) All laptops, workstations and systems must be locked manually or signed off when leaving the host unattended.
- 15) All devices connecting to the IBEX network must be equipped with an approved anti-malware and monitoring solutions.
- 16) Employees must use extreme caution when opening links or e-mail attachments received from unknown senders, which may contain viruses, e-mail bombs, or Trojan horse code etc.
- 17) Users must remain vigilant against unsolicited phone calls or SMS messages, taking necessary steps to verify identities and counter social engineering attempts.
- 18) All company-provided mobile devices shall be secured with a mandatory password or PIN-protected screen lock. Furthermore, all such devices shall be enrolled in and managed by the organization's centralized Mobile Device Management (MDM) solution to ensure continuous security oversight.
- 19) Employees must avoid connecting IBEX provided computing assets to open networks e.g., airports, cafes, etc. However, if absolutely needed, IBEX VPN shall be connected immediately after connecting to open and public networks and before performing any task.
- 20) All third-party and open-source applications must be vetted and approved by IT Security prior to use. Uploading sensitive company data into unauthorized tools is strictly prohibited.

4.3. Unacceptable Use

IBEX maintains a zero-tolerance policy regarding the use of corporate resources for any activity that violates local, regional, national, or international laws and regulations. All employees are strictly prohibited from engaging in illegal conduct while utilizing company-owned assets or network infrastructure.

The following sections outline specific activities categorized as unacceptable use. While these lists serve as a comprehensive framework, they are not exhaustive. Any deviation from these restrictions for legitimate business purposes requires formal justification and prior written authorization from the relevant Department Head and the IT Security team.

4.3.1. Physical Activities

Authorized personnel are issued physical access cards to facilitate entry into specific areas (e.g., data centers, production floors) based strictly on business requirements or job need. Any attempt to bypass security controls or gain unauthorized entry into restricted zones is a severe policy violation and may be subjective to disciplinary actions. The prohibition against physical security are as follows:

- 21) Transferring or sharing assigned access cards with any other individual—including colleagues—except when returning the card directly to Human Resources.
- 22) Granting unauthorized entry to others into secured areas by utilizing personal credentials, commonly referred to as "tailgating" or "piggybacking."
- 23) Introducing unauthorized recording devices to the production floor, including but not limited to cell phones, smartwatches, cameras, or any voice/image recording equipment.
- 24) Bringing personal computing or storage assets into restricted zones, such as tablets, handhelds, personal laptops, handbags, carry cases, or any writable media.

- 25) Failing to report the theft, loss, or suspected compromise of any IBEX equipment or access credentials to the relevant teams immediately.
- 26) Neglecting the security and maintenance of assigned access cards, whether on-site or off-site, to prevent unauthorized use.
- 27) Utilizing company assets to facilitate any of the aforementioned prohibited activities or to bypass established physical security protocols.

4.3.2. Email and Communication Activities

Users are prohibited from:

- 28) Distributing unsolicited electronic communications, including "junk mail," unauthorized advertising, or mass postings to newsgroups (spamming) via corporate systems.
- 29) Engaging in any form of harassment through email, telephone, or any other digital communication channels.
- 30) Communicating in an unprofessional manner or failing to ensure that all corporate dialogue remains consistent with organizational values and ethical standards.
- 31) Forging, spoofing, or unauthorized altering of email header information or any other digital identity markers to disguise the origin of a communication.
- 32) Soliciting emails or collecting replies for any account other than the user's assigned corporate account, especially for the purposes of harassment or unauthorized data harvesting.
- 33) Disclosing proprietary or confidential information via social media, public forums, or any external digital platform, regardless of the communication method used.
- 34) Utilizing personal social media accounts while on the production floor or during designated restricted work hours.
- 35) Participating in digital campaigns or public activities that may tarnish the image, reputation, or goodwill of IBEX or its stakeholders.
- 36) Failing to adhere to ethical standards or legal obligations when utilizing public forums or social media, ensuring no conduct infringes upon the organization's reputation.
- 37) Interfering with the communication systems of others or attempting to circumvent security controls related to digital messaging.

4.3.3. System and Network Activities

The following activities are strictly prohibited, with no exceptions:

- 38) Violating intellectual property rights, including the unauthorized installation, distribution, or "piracy" of software, images, or documentation; all utilized software shall be appropriately licensed and approved.
- 39) Exporting software or technical information in violation of international or regional export control laws; management shall be consulted prior to the export of any encryption technology or restricted material.
- 40) Removing corporate assets from designated premises without explicit management authorization, particularly devices containing client or proprietary information.

- 41) Connecting personal or unauthorized devices—including USB drives, flash drives, or smartphones—to the IBEX network or corporate assets without prior approval from IT Security and the relevant business owner.
- 42) Tampering with or making unauthorized changes to hardware or software configurations on any IBEX computing asset.
- 43) Intentionally propagating malicious programs, such as viruses, ransomware, worms, or Trojan horses, into IBEX networks and systems.
- 44) Sharing, revealing, or compromising access credentials with any individual, including colleagues or family members; users shall remain uniquely accountable for all activities performed under their assigned accounts.
- 45) Engaging in fraudulent activities, such as making fraudulent offers of products or services originating from any IBEX account.
- 46) Causing security breaches or network disruptions, including unauthorized port scanning, vulnerability scanning, network sniffing, ping floods, packet spoofing, or denial-of-service (DoS) attacks.
- 47) Circumventing user authentication or security controls e.g., bypassing of EDR, MDM, DLP, Privileged Access Management (PAM), or Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) tools.
- 48) Installing unauthorized software designed to circumvent established security controls or facilitate unauthorized access.
- 49) Interfering with or disabling user sessions through the use of programs, scripts, or commands, whether locally or via the internet.
- 50) Disclosing sensitive information regarding IBEX employees or clients to external third parties without authorization.
- 51) Storing non-business-related materials, such as personal images, audio, or video files, on IBEX-owned systems.
- 52) Utilizing real production data in non-production or testing environments without explicit, documented approval.

4.3.4. AI Systems and Technologies

- 53) Inputting IBEX proprietary, confidential, or sensitive client information into any public or unauthorized AI platform that has not been explicitly approved by IT Security.
- 54) Using AI tools to generate discriminatory, deceptive, offensive, or otherwise harmful materials that infringe upon the IBEX Code of Conduct.
- 55) Facilitating the unauthorized scraping of data or generating content that knowingly infringes upon third-party copyrights, trademarks, or patents through AI systems.
- 56) Leveraging AI technologies to automate malicious activities, including the development of malware, the execution of phishing campaigns, or performing unauthorized vulnerability research.
- 57) Attempting to circumvent or "jailbreak" the safety filters, ethical guardrails, or security configurations of any authorized AI platform.
- 58) Feeding real production data or PII (Personally Identifiable Information) into AI models for testing or training purposes without documented approval from the Data Privacy officer.

- 59) Using AI to generate or manipulate audio and video content for the purpose of impersonating leadership, colleagues, customers, or any other stakeholder (e.g., "Deepfakes").
- 60) Utilizing AI systems in a manner that violates applicable data protection laws and regulations.

5. Enforcement

Any employee found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including immediate termination of employment.

6. Definitions and Abbreviations

Abb. & Definition	Descriptions
MDM	Mobile Device Management
GNOG	Global Network Operations Center
EDR	Endpoint Detection and Response
DLP	Data Loss Protection
Information Owner	All users who are in charge of handling information
VPN	Virtual Private Network
AI	Artificial Intelligence

7. Revision History

Version	Date	Details of Changes	Change By	Reviewed By	Approved By
1.0	06/07/2010	Initial Draft	Romail Neil	Farakh Hussain	Farakh Hussain
2.1	09/04/2013	Rebranded to IBEX GLOBAL	Qamber & Emal Khan	Waseem Ahmad	Waseem Ahmad
2.2	09/03/2018	Added Mobile Devices and Format Changes	Muqheet Kamal	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
3.0	02/17/2020	Added Physical Activities and changes to unacceptable use	Muqheet Kamal	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
3.1	3/5/2021	Minor Changes	Muhammad Shahzad	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
3.2	2/28/2022	Minor Changes	Muhammad Shahzad	M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
3.3	2/28/2023	Minor Changes	Sidra Maryam	Muhammad Shahzad M. Atif Naseem	Mubsshar Ismail
3.4	3/7/2024	Section on Print and removable Media and Mobile Device usage added in	Sidra Maryam	Muhammad Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail
3.5	2/10/2025	Data governance and AI usage guidelines added	Iftikhar Zafar	Muhammad Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail
3.6	2/24/2026	Revamped to eliminate redundancies and formalize prohibitions regarding AI misuse	Sidra Maryam	Muhammad Shahzad	Mubsshar Ismail